

From: Cian Mac Liatháin D00274413@student.dkit.ie
Subject: University of Galway Complaint OMB-152443-V2W8R5Fwd: Query
re Application to the University of Galway Ref:0100798174
Date: 27 Jun 2025 at 09:23:08
To: Ombudsman Complaints OMB complaints@ombudsman.ie
Cc: Michal Molcho michal.molcho@universityofgalway.ie, Cornelia
Connolly cornelia.connolly@universityofgalway.ie, Maeve McCaldin
maeve.mccaldin@universityofgalway.ie, maire.niriordain@ucc.ie,
Kathy O'Sullivan kathy.osullivan@universityofgalway.ie

Hi Barry Quirke etal.

You requested further evidence of me having tried my best to
follow the appeals process of the University of Galway

Appeals process incorrectly followed, Natalie Walsh incorrectly
refused me entry to the MGO and the Professor in charge of the
appeals sarcastically emphasised mental health challenges
completely irrelevant to the illogicality of the decline of entry
into MGO programme.

CCed are those relevant to this complaint.

See attached evidence, Professor Becky Whay's last email to
me stating she refuses to appeal, and refuses to accept
complaint about the mishandling of my application.

Why is the Ombudsman so ambivalent when presented with
instances of ableist exucational abuse?

Sent from my iPhone

Begin forwarded message:

From: Cian Mac Liatháin <D00274413@student.dkit.ie>
Date: 26 June 2025 at 17:23:14 IST
To: Becky Whay <becky.whay@universityofgalway.ie>
Cc: Maeve McCaldin

<maeve.mccaldin@universityofgalway.ie>, Cornelia Connolly
<cornelia.connolly@universityofgalway.ie>,
caitrona.nicdhonncha@gretb.ie,
moirin.nicfhlanncadha@gretb.ie, Dean of Students
<deanofstudents@universityofgalway.ie>

**Subject: Re: Query re Application to the University of
Galway Ref:0100798174**

You are stating that I am not allowed do the MGO because
Coláiste na Coiribe won't allow me to teach Computer Science
or Maths?

Having a BME is not a balid reason to deny someone entry to
the MGO. Yes they will. I fully qualify and I will require in writing
why exactly I cannot choose Matamaitic/Gaeilge/
Ríomheolaíocht for the MGO this September before I proceed
with a complaint to the Dean of Students.

On 26 Jun 2025, at 17:10, Whay, Becky
<becky.whay@universityofgalway.ie> wrote:

You don't often get email from becky.whay@universityofgalway.ie. [Learn why this is important](#)

Caution: This is an external email and may be malicious.
Please take care when clicking links or opening attachments.

Dear Cian,

Thank you for your e-mail and I am very sorry to hear of your
mental health challenges and the impact that this has on you.

In regard to you not receiving an offer for the Máistreacht Ghairmiúil san Oideachas (MGO), I have been in contact with the school and examined the decision-making process that they undertook. I deem their process to be fair and transparent and concur with the reasons they give for not making you an offer to study on this programme.

As a result, I cannot uphold your appeal.

On the basis that I believe the application review process the school undertook and which Natalie Walsh communicated to you was appropriate, fair and transparent, I do not consider that there are grounds to pursue a complaint against her.

Mise le meas,

Professor Becky Whay

Professor Becky Whay

An tUachtarán Ionaid agus Meabhránaí | Deputy President and Registrar

Oifig an Uachtaráin Ionaid agus Meabhránaí | Office of the Deputy President and Registrar
T : +353 (0)91 492121



OLLSCOIL NA GAILLIMHE
UNIVERSITY OF GALWAY

University
ofGalway.ie

University of Galway is a registered charity RCN 20002107

From: Cian Mac Liatháin <D00274413@student.dkit.ie>

Sent: 25 June 2025 17:43

To: Deputy President and Registrar <dpr@universityofgalway.ie>

Subject: Complaint against Natalie Walsh Fwd: Please help. Fwd: Following your email to me recently Fwd: These aren't valid reasons to decline my application, College of Arts. Re: Query re Application to the University of Galway Ref:0100798174

You don't often get email from d00274413@student.dkit.ie.
[Learn why this is important](#)

Professor Whay,

I know you don't know me. My application for the College of Arts -> School of Education course the Máistreacht Ghairmiúil san Oideachas was declined by Natalie Walsh due to me having an English teaching qualification and, according to her, the subject Ríomheolaíocht not being available on the course.

The fact that I am already a qualified teacher in English is a good thing showing my preparation to complete the MGO in Irish, and Ríomheolaíocht IS a module available on the course.

Neither of her responses are relevant reasons to dismiss an application, and the latter reason is completely UNTRUE and insults the intelligence of the course directors and other peers of mine of the School of Education.

I have a severe mental health disability that hinders my ability to feel valuable or ask for help - Complex Post Traumatic Stress Disorder.

I am having difficulty following Natalie's link, can you accept this email as my complaint against her ableism and invalid rejection from a course I am fully qualified for and would be an asset to - a conclusion drawn based on my past lecturers' feedback to me in the School of Education

Mise le meas,
Cian Mac Liatháin
11476078

Sent from my iPhone

Begin forwarded message:

From: Cian Mac Liatháin <cian.lyons@icloud.com>
Date: 25 June 2025 at 16:57:55 IST
To: Admissions Arts <artsadmissions@universityofgalway.ie>
Cc: D00274413@student.dkit.ie, Cornelia Connolly
<cornelia.connolly@universityofgalway.ie>, Seán Ó Grádaigh
<sean.ogradaigh@universityofgalway.ie>, Maeve McCaldin
<maeve.mccaldin@universityofgalway.ie>,
maire.niriordain@ucc.ie, Kathy O'Sullivan
<kathy.osullivan@universityofgalway.ie>, Dean of Students
<deanofstudents@universityofgalway.ie>, Michal Molcho
<michal.molcho@universityofgalway.ie>, President University of
Galway <president@universityofgalway.ie>, Admissions Arts
<artsadmissions@universityofgalway.ie>
Subject: Re: Please help. Fwd: Following your email to me
recently Fwd: These aren't valid reasons to decline my
application, College of Arts. Re: Query re Application to the
University of Galway Ref:0100798174

You don't often get email from cian.lyons@icloud.com. [Learn why this is important](#)

Caution: This is an external email and may be malicious.
Please take care when clicking links or opening attachments.

Natalie the reason you dismissed my application was false,

Computer Science is an available module on the MGO.

So therefore offer me the place I qualify for?

My official complaint has been submitted to you via email as advised in your rejection to me. Why am I now forced to repeat myself, it's retraumatising?

On 25 Jun 2025, at 15:26, Arts Admissions
<artsadmissions@universityofgalway.ie> wrote:

Dear Cian

Thank you for reaching out to us. I am very sorry to hear that you are unhappy with the decision regarding your application to the MGO.

We understand the importance of this matter to you and wish to advise that we have a formal appeals process as part of the Admissions Procedures [HERE](#), which you can follow. This process is outlined under the section titled '*Complaints and Appeals*'.

Please send your formal appeal to the Deputy President and Registrar, Professor Becky Whay.

Email: dpr@universityofgalway.ie.

If you have any further questions, please do let me know.

Kindest regards,

Natalie

Comhordaitheoir Iontrála Iarchéime | Postgraduate Admissions Coordinator

Coláiste na nDán, na nEolaíochtaí Sóisialta & an Léinn Cheiltigh
College of Arts, Social Sciences & Celtic Studies



OLLSCOIL NA GAILLIMHE
UNIVERSITY OF GALWAY

University
ofGalway.ie

Uimhir Carthanachta Cláraithe/Registered Charity Number 20002107

From: Cian Mac Liatháin <D00274413@student.dkit.ie>

Sent: 25 June 2025 09:51

To: artsadmissions@ollscoilnagaillimhe.ie <artsadmissions@ollscoilnagaillimhe.ie>

Cc: Connolly, Cornelia <cornelia.connolly@universityofgalway.ie>; Ó Grádaigh, Seán <sean.ogradaigh@universityofgalway.ie>; McCaldin, Maeve <maeve.mccaldin@universityofgalway.ie>; maire.niriordain@ucc.ie <maire.niriordain@ucc.ie>; O'Sullivan, Kathy <kathy.osullivan@nuigalway.ie>

Subject: Please help. Fwd: Following your email to me recently Fwd:
These aren't valid reasons to decline my application, College of Arts.
Re: Query re Application to the University of Galway Ref:0100798174

Hi Natalie,

I got this contact from the NUIG switchboard. I know you don't know me, but please read the below forwarded email from bottom up and see my application the ellianrecruitment website.

I am the most qualified and best option to attend/improve/wenjoy the MGO this year.

For further clarification on what I mean, please also feel free to contact those CCes in the below emails regarding my academic stature here since 2011, and how my Disability effects me (James McCormack, Maeve McCaldin)

I deserve to be given a place on the MGO this year after what I've been through since graduating the BME in 2021.

If the place requires changes to my application e.g. teaching Maths and Irish instead of computer science etc, then I will do so. Graduating the BME most CERTAINLY does not preclude me from the MGO, it informs the allocation and leaves my merits within its context.

Mise le meas,

Cian

11476078

Sent from my iPhone

Begin forwarded message:

From: Cian Mac Liatháin <D00274413@student.dkit.ie>

Date: 24 June 2025 at 13:53:58 IST

To: President University of Galway
<president@universityofgalway.ie>,
peter.mchugh@ollscoilnagaillimhe.ie

Cc: Dean of Students

<deanofstudents@universityofgalway.ie>, Maeve McCaldin
<maeve.mccaldin@universityofgalway.ie>,
maire.niriordain@ucc.ie,

cornelia.connolly@universityofgalway.ie,

sean.ogradaigh@universityofgalway.ie

Subject: Following your email to me recently Fwd: These aren't valid reasons to decline my application, College of Arts. Re: Query re Application to the University of Galway Ref:0100798174

I was advised by your office that my application would be treated fairly based on my merits.

My application has been dismissed for invalid reasons. I can teach maths/applied maths/coding/comp science BECAUSE I'm already fully qualified.

This MGO is part of my therapeutic recovery from the trauma caused to me by NUIG Security false reports against me damaging my reputation.

I will be offered a place on the MGO, as I have earnt.

I was given a sarcastic dismissal, based on random technicalities that aren't even important to the application or my ability to perform on the course, and given NO accommodations for this disabled student.

I command a meeting with Applications Admin and Maeve McCaldin if I don't get offered a place, or my solicitor will be in touch.

Mise le meas,

Cian

Sent from my iPhone

Begin forwarded message:

From: Cian Mac Liatháin <D00274413@student.dkit.ie>

Date: 24 June 2025 at 13:31:55 IST

To: applicationenquiry@universityofgalway.ie,
admissions@universityofgalway.ie

Cc: cornelia.connolly@universityofgalway.ie, Maeve

McCaldin <maeve.mccaldin@universityofgalway.ie>,

President University of Galway

<president@universityofgalway.ie>,

sean.ogradaigh@universityofgalway.ie, Dean of Students

<deanofstudents@universityofgalway.ie>,

maire.niriordain@ucc.ie,

michal.molcho@universityofgalway.ie

Subject: These aren't valid reasons to decline my application, College of Arts. Re: Query re Application to the University of Galway Ref:0100798174

Excuse me,

This is not a valid reason to refuse me entry into the MGO.

Coláiste na Coiribe is a VEC school. I am retraining to qualify as Gaeilge.

I qualify for the course, why did you dismiss my qualification?

That was not warranted, it was traumatising. I will gladly teach Maths then, but you do not speak for the School of Education.

I most certainly should be offered a place.

I am the most qualified graduate of the BME. I can change whatever subject I choose to study in September.

You will be offering me a place now, then, no?

Regardless of what you state the main purpose of the MGO is, what I spend my money on academically and how and where I study is my prerogative. I am fully Garda vetted, I am welcome at this University and at the School of Education and at Coláiste na Coiribe

your sudden decline of my postgraduate course request after paying €100 should be reviewed.

Would you not agree?

Mise Lemass,

Cian Mac Liatháin (Uí dhéisigh)

Cian Lyons Deacy

11476078

4416038

Apple Inc Award winner in the Apple Hall of Fame who will improve the Apple Distinguished School Status of UoG and CnaC

Sent from my iPhone

On 24 Jun 2025, at 13:03, DO NOT REPLY - application enquiry <applicationenquiry@universityofgalway.ie> wrote:

Dear Cian

Thank you for taking the time to apply to the MGO programme.

We truly appreciate the effort you put into your application.

Please be advised that because you have successfully completed the Bachelor of Arts in Math's & Education, you have been awarded a teaching qualification, and so you are already a qualified teacher at post primary level in Ireland. The main benefit of completing the MGO is to qualify as a second level teacher, a qualification you already have.

Please also note that in reference to your personal

statement letter expressing your interest in teaching Coding at junior cycle and Computer Science at senior cycle. Neither of these two subjects are available on the MGO programme.

For the above reasons, your application must be declined. If you have any questions please do reach out to artsadmissions@universityofgalway.ie.

Kind regards

Natalie

Postgraduate Admissions Coordinator

From: Cian Lyons cian.lyons@icloud.com
Subject: Case Number: OMB-152443-V2W8R5
Date: 26 Jun 2025 at 17:46:12
To: OMB Ombudsman Complaints complaints@ombudsman.ie
Cc: Maeve McCaldin maeve.mccaldin@universityofgalway.ie,
maire.niriordain@ucc.ie, Cornelia Connolly
cornelia.connolly@universityofgalway.ie

Re: Require Ombudsman inspection of University of Galway's bias against Whistleblower/ Disabled Student Re:

Your information was not accurate in the response below.

After recovering from brain damage and a near-death experience, due to your ambivalence in processing my, why have you not proceeded with complaint.

OMB- 152395-S1W4J3 - there are no further details needed. I did not mentioned GSOC and Gardaí were 'currently' involved. The security team of University of Galway assaulted me in two different incidences and after submitting an official complaint process with the University attached blow that was never processed by the University instead they decided to suspend me academically instead



**QA611-Nós-imeachta-OÉ-
Gaillimh-do-Mhic-Léinn-**
448 KB

So I require the Ombudsman to investigate the illegalities of the security assaults upon my body, reputation and the Dean of Students / President suspending me and NEVER appropriately replying to my complaint attached above. I have been incapacitated since the assault that the suspension caused as they called me a threat to the campus which is emphatically untrue.

On 22 Oct 2024, at 15:28, OMB Ombudsman Complaints
<complaints@ombudsman.ie> wrote:

Dear Mr Mac Liatháin,

To date you have submitted two complaints against University of Galway (UG) to this office. I would appreciate if you could provide the following information in relation to these complaints.

Complaint one- OMB- 152395-S1W4J3 is in relation to two separate alleged assaults by security at NUIG in 2019 and 2023. Having viewed your correspondence, you mention that the GSOC and the Gardaí are currently involved. The Ombudsman cannot not investigate matters of a criminal nature and therefore this aspect of your complaint may be outside the Ombudsman's remit. If I have misunderstood your complaint, can you please provide additional information to clarify the current status. You may also provide any response you received from UG in relation to this complaint.

Complaint two - OMB-142443-V2W8R5 relates to an allegation of slander by a professor and a request for an apology. Can you please provide a copy of the complaint you submitted to UG and any response received? Can you also provide specific details of the complaint?

I would appreciate if you could provide the requested information and I will then be in a position to consider the matter further.

I note you are currently suspended from UG and this process is ongoing. The Ombudsman cannot not investigate a complaint until the process is complete. If you are unhappy with the outcome of this process, you can revert to this Office and we will consider it then.

Kind regards
Peter Hardiman

Please use Reply to Option to respond to this Office

Peter Hardiman, Investigator, Office of the Ombudsman, 6 Earlsfort Terrace, Dublin 2 D02 W773 | 01-6395600 | www.ombudsman.ie

----- Original Message -----

From: Mac Liatháin, Cian;

Received: Sat Oct 12 2024 19:27:42 GMT+0100 (Irish Standard Time)

To: Complaints, Ombudsman; Ombudsman Complaints;

Cc: Ciara.Meehan@universityofgalway.ie; professionalstandards@teachingcouncil.ie;

Subject: Require Ombudsman inspection of University of Galway's bias against Whistleblower/ Ableist Re: Case Number: OMB-152443-V2W8R5

CAUTION: This eMail originated from outside your organisation and the BTS Managed Desktop service. Do not click on any links or open any attachments unless you recognise the sender or are expecting the email and know that the content is safe. If you are in any doubt, please contact the OGCI0 IT Service Desk.

No, the suspension was invalid and the meeting can not go ahead due to ableist bias

disallowing my Disability Advisor to be present. You have communicated to the University, taken their presumption of my suspension as fact, failed to acknowledge the validity of my complaint?

The ongoing complaints process of University of Galway is traumatising to my registered Disability at University of Galway of Anxiety Disorder and Complex Post Traumatic Stress Disorder.

Why have they not processed my valid complaint submitted against them prior to my suspension first?

I cannot attend their meeting until that complaint is processed.

Why am I being punished for following the valid complaints procedure?

I am in hospital due to physical injury and the stress of a sudden unwarranted suspension. Why is the fact that I submitted a valid complaint prior to the suspension and never heard anything back + the fact I'm in hospital so need nothing but access to the emergency fund and my lectures not being taken into account?

A disabled student in an emergency situation (COMPLETELY invalid cause for a SUSPENSION) must certainly prioritise Maslow's Hierarchy prior to further adhering to Ollscoil na Gaillimhe's complaints process would you not agree?

From: OMB Ombudsman Complaints <complaints@ombudsman.ie>

Date: Monday, 7 October 2024 at 11:51

To: Mac Liatháin, Cian <cianmacliathain@gmail.com>

Subject: Case Number: OMB-152443-V2W8R5

Dear Mr Mac Liatháin,

I have reviewed the correspondence you have submitted to this Office. In an email you submitted to this Office from the University of Galway (UG) dated 1 Oct 2024, it refers to a Stage 3 meeting which is due to take place within the next fortnight. As such this Office considers the matter ongoing.

When you have received confirmation of the outcome of the Stage 3 meeting, it is

open to you to revert to this Office with UG's decision letter and the issues you wish to raise. The Ombudsman will consider the matter at that stage.

Kind regards,

Dylan McDonnell
Caseworker

**Tabhair freagra ar an ríomhphost seo ach an rogha 'tabhair freagra do' a úsáid
nó seol ríomhphost chuig complaints@ombudsman.ie, agus an Uimhir
Thagartha á lua agat i líne ábhair an ríomhphoist.**

**Please respond to this email by using the reply to option or email complaints@ombudsman.ie with the
Reference No. in the email Subject line.**

Office of the Ombudsman, 6 Earlsfort Terrace, Dublin 2, D02 W773 | * complaints@ombudsman.ie | (+353-1)
639 5600 | www.ombudsman.ie

From: Dean of Students deanofstudents@universityofgalway.ie 
Subject: Re: Question regarding University of Galway suspension and complaints process
Date: 26 September 2024 at 10:54
To: Cian Mac Liatháin cmacliathain01@qub.ac.uk

Dear Cian,

Thank you for your email. I am very sorry to read about the assault, and I hope you're doing okay after it. I will follow up with ISS to determine how you can access your University of Galway account without your phone. Do you have access to a phone at all at the moment? If so, we should be able to set you up with access via that, but I'll check the specifics and come back to you.

I can assure you, I have responded to you. Due to the problems accessing your account, you are unlikely to have seen my reply to your earlier emails. I have both attached it to this email, and copied the content below. In line with the terms of your temporary suspension, please ensure when you email that you are using the Dean of Students email account only; Maeve, and other colleagues, should not be copied in.

All best wishes,
Ciara

Content of email sent to c.maclithain2@universityofgalway.ie, 25/09/2024

Dear Cian,

Thank you for taking time to set out your response to the notice about a temporary suspension and support, invoked under QA269. I have shared this also with the review panel that will meet you as part of the QA269 stage three process, so that they are aware of your feedback. There will also be further opportunities for you to comment, once the chair of the panel has been in contact with you. Full details about the stage 3 process can be found in appendix 4 of the attached document.

In the meantime, below are responses to some of your questions.

You were asked not to include other email addresses in your correspondence with this Office. I have removed Maeve McCaldin from my reply. I would ask you to adhere to this request in any future emails. Please note, the typical response time from my Office is three working days.

Please remember, Cian, this suspension is a temporary measure, taken with a view to the duty of care owed to both yourself and the University community. We want to work with you.

All best wishes,
Ciara

1. **Do I still have access to student service like free legal aid?** Yes, as a student of University of Galway you retain the right to access student services. Throughout your suspension, all queries must be directed to and through deanofstudents@universityofgalway.ie only.
2. **Did I threaten anyone or claim to be aggressive or self-harming?** Details of concerns that caused the temporary suspension and support under QA269 to

be invoked have been recorded in a 'note of concern' that will be shared with you by the review panel as part of the stage 3 process. I have re-attached the policy, sent in my email of 20 September, for ease of access.

3. **Your concerns for my wellbeing are unwarranted. I am not in crisis, what gave you that impression?** As above.
4. **What serious grounds, can you elaborate to me were deemed serious or concerning? Did I clog your IMAP servers?** As above.
5. **I will retain full right to contact my Disability Advisor Maeve McCaldin, though?** Yes, as a student of University of Galway you retain the right to access student services. Throughout your suspension, all queries must be directed to and through deanofstudents@universityofgalway.ie only.
6. **How is this review panel arranged, do any of them know me personally? You drew a false conclusion I believe.** Membership of the review panel is set out in Appendix 4, section 2 'Membership' (attached). Here is the relevant extract:

The Review Panel shall be constituted as follows:

- Chairperson, appointed by the President or Designated Authority
 - Academic Secretary, or nominee, as secretary to the panel
 - Three members, selected by the Registrar & Deputy President, from the panel nominated by the Academic Council
 - Two student representatives, normally members of the Student Union Executive.
7. **Am I free to access the Student Emergency Fund? I receive Disability Allowance for my perfectly self-managed anxiety / trauma / identity disorder.** Yes, as a student of University of Galway you retain the right to access student services. Throughout your suspension, all queries must be directed to and through deanofstudents@universityofgalway.ie only.
 8. **Have plenty pdfs of references from those more expert than me in terms of psychological or educational claims of mine.** You will be invited to submit any relevant documentation to the review panel in advance of the meeting.
 9. **And how many representatives can I bring to this review panel? Maeve McCaldin, Kathy O'Sullivan and Cornelia Connolly please.** As per Appendix 4, section 4.3 of QA269 (attached): 'The student may be accompanied at the meeting by a Students' Union representative, a fellow student or family member or others as appropriate. Students with a disability may also be accompanied by a support worker where required'.
 10. **I am estranged from my adult family and distant from my grandmother and younger siblings, represent myself, I repeat am not at risk... what counter information and from whom are you claiming I deserve suspension?** As per Appendix 4, section 4.2 of QA269 (attached): 'The student will be invited in writing to attend and given at least 7 days' notice of the Review Meeting and informed of the purpose of the meeting. They will also be provided with copies of any documents, which will be considered in the meeting'

11. **If I wrote this email in my mother tongue of Gaeilge would you find that more misconstruingly offensive?** You are welcome to correspond with me as Gaeilge.
12. **You were quick to send me this suspension, what about a reply for the valid complaint I've already submitted to NUIG following your complaints process?** I have consulted with the Students' Union on your complaint as SULT is operated by the SU, not University of Galway. The SU has confirmed that security working at SULT are not University of Galway employees, which means that I am not in a position to progress the complaint in its current form. The SU, however, can investigate the complaint. With your complaint, I can officially forward your complaint to them.
13. **Let me make a list of all the above questions to simplify your reply, it is my right as a BME graduate to require you to reply to each one as that is what a teacher does, no?** Queries will be answered within a reasonable timeframe.
14. **I am estranged from my adult family and distant from my grandmother and younger siblings, represent myself, I repeat am not at risk... what counter information and from whom are you claiming I deserve suspension?** Answered above.
15. **If I wrote this email in my mother tongue of Gaeilge would you find that more misconstruingly offensive?** Answered above.
16. **You were quick to send me this suspension, what about a reply for the valid complaint I've already submitted to NUIG following your complaints process?** Answered above.
17. **What serious grounds, can you elaborate to me were deemed serious or concerning? Did I clog your IMAP servers?** Answered above.
18. **I will retain full right to contact my Disability Advisor Maeve McCaldin, though?** Answered above.
19. **I am a remote student, I live safe and sound in Belfast, your suspension and suggestion of myself from physically attending the campus is rather irrelevant and misinterpretation of my written text is not my prerogative – English is my second language. What makes you think your concerns are warranted?** Details of concerns that caused the temporary suspension and support under QA269 to be invoked have been recorded in a 'note of concern' that will be shared with you by the review panel as part of the stage 3 process.

Prof Ciara Meehan (she/her)

Déan na Mac Léinn | Dean of Students



Uimhir Carthanachta Cláraithe/Registered Charity Number 20002107

From: Cian Mac Liatháin <cmacliathain01@qub.ac.uk>
Sent: 26 September 2024 10:37
To: Dean of Students <deanofstudents@universityofgalway.ie>
Cc: McCaldin, Maeve <maeve.mccaldin@universityofgalway.ie>; Meehan, Ciara <Ciara.Meehan@universityofgalway.ie>
Subject: Question regarding University of Galway suspension and complaints process

EXTERNAL EMAIL: This email originated outside the University of Galway. Do not open attachments or click on links unless you believe the content is safe.

RÍOMHPHOST SEACHTRACH: Níor tháinig an ríomhphost seo ó Ollscoil na Gaillimhe. Ná hoscail ceangaltáin agus ná cliceáil ar naisc mura gcreideann tú go bhfuil an t-ábhar sábháilte.

As previously discussed, I was told only to contact the Dean of Students email (and obviously I retain the right to contact my peers and previous lecturers as is my right as an alumnus – the suspension was with regard to my status as a postgraduate student, not a suspension of my memory nor rights as a citizen/alumnus) and have received no responses from this email.

As a victim of assault recently, I seem to be locked out of my University of Galway emails and am unsure if this is coincidental with the sudden and shocking suspension for the first time after a great tenure of 12 years at NUIG, shortly following my official complaint against NUIG Security – a complaint I received no update from but was quick to be suspended.

As previously iterated, I was a patient of a Professor Colm McDonald and was within my right to begin a Medical Council complaints process against him – my written word seems to have been misconstrued as a threat to your campus, which luckily due to the Freedom of Information act and IMAP server records I'll be able to refute.

You wouldn't blame a student for having CPTSD and sustaining a concussion, would you?

I'm safe and sound under the protection of the PSNI in Belfast, but without my phone, how can I access my email account and Canvas as is my right as a student of University of Galway?

From: Dean of Students deanofstudents@universityofgalway.ie 
Subject: Re: Thanks for the Notice, what about the complaint submitted first? Re: Notice of Temporary Suspension and Support under QA269
Date: 25 September 2024 at 10:29
To: MAC LIATHÁIN, CIAN C.MACLIATHAIN2@universityofgalway.ie

Dear Cian,

Thank you for taking time to set out your response to the notice about a temporary suspension and support, invoked under QA269. I have shared this also with the review panel that will meet you as part of the QA269 stage three process, so that they are aware of your feedback. There will also be further opportunities for you to comment, once the chair of the panel has been in contact with you. Full details about the stage 3 process can be found in appendix 4 of the attached document.

In the meantime, below are responses to some of your questions.

You were asked not to include other email addresses in your correspondence with this Office. I have removed Maeve McCaldin from my reply. I would ask you to adhere to this request in any future emails. Please note, the typical response time from my Office is three working days.

Please remember, Cian, this suspension is a temporary measure, taken with a view to the duty of care owed to both yourself and the University community. We want to work with you.

All best wishes,
Ciara

1. **Do I still have access to student service like free legal aid?** Yes, as a student of University of Galway you retain the right to access student services. Throughout your suspension, all queries must be directed to and through deanofstudents@universityofgalway.ie only.
2. **Did I threaten anyone or claim to be aggressive or self-harming?** Details of concerns that caused the temporary suspension and support under QA269 to be invoked have been recorded in a 'note of concern' that will be shared with you by the review panel as part of the stage 3 process. I have re-attached the policy, sent in my email of 20 September, for ease of access.
3. **Your concerns for my wellbeing are unwarranted. I am not in crisis, what gave you that impression?** As above.
4. **What serious grounds, can you elaborate to me were deemed serious or concerning? Did I clog your IMAP servers?** As above.
5. **I will retain full right to contact my Disability Advisor Maeve McCaldin, though?** Yes, as a student of University of Galway you retain the right to access student services. Throughout your suspension, all queries must be directed to and through deanofstudents@universityofgalway.ie only.
6. **How is this review panel arranged, do any of them know me personally? You drew a false conclusion I believe.** Membership of the review panel is set out in Appendix 4, section 2 'Membership' (attached). Here is the relevant extract:

The Review Panel shall be constituted as follows:

- Chairperson, appointed by the President or Designated Authority
- Academic Secretary, or nominee, as secretary to the panel
- Three members, selected by the Registrar & Deputy President, from the panel nominated by the Academic Council
- Two student representatives, normally members of the Student Union Executive.

7. **Am I free to access the Student Emergency Fund? I receive Disability Allowance for my perfectly self-managed anxiety / trauma / identity disorder.** Yes, as a student of University of Galway you retain the right to access student services. Throughout your suspension, all queries must be directed to and through deanofstudents@universityofgalway.ie only.
8. **Have plenty pdfs of references from those more expert than me in terms of psychological or educational claims of mine.** You will be invited to submit any relevant documentation to the review panel in advance of the meeting.
9. **And how many representatives can I bring to this review panel? Maeve McCaldin, Kathy O'Sullivan and Cornelia Connolly please.** As per Appendix 4, section 4.3 of QA269 (attached): 'The student may be accompanied at the meeting by a Students' Union representative, a fellow student or family member or others as appropriate. Students with a disability may also be accompanied by a support worker where required'.
10. **I am estranged from my adult family and distant from my grandmother and younger siblings, represent myself, I repeat am not at risk... what counter information and from whom are you claiming I deserve suspension?** As per Appendix 4, section 4.2 of QA269 (attached): 'The student will be invited in writing to attend and given at least 7 days' notice of the Review Meeting and informed of the purpose of the meeting. They will also be provided with copies of any documents, which will be considered in the meeting'
11. **If I wrote this email in my mother tongue of Gaeilge would you find that more misconstruingly offensive?** You are welcome to correspond with me as Gaeilge.
12. **You were quick to send me this suspension, what about a reply for the valid complaint I've already submitted to NUIG following your complaints process?** I have consulted with the Students' Union on your complaint as SULT is operated by the SU, not University of Galway. The SU has confirmed that security working at SULT are not University of Galway employees, which means that I am not in a position to progress the complaint in its current form. The SU, however, can investigate the complaint. With your complaint, I can officially forward your complaint to them.
13. **Let me make a list of all the above questions to simplify your reply, it is my right as a BME graduate to require you to reply to each one as that is what a teacher does, no?** Queries will be answered within a reasonable timeframe.

14. **I am estranged from my adult family and distant from my grandmother**

14. **I am estranged from my adult family and distant from my grandmother and younger siblings, represent myself, I repeat am not at risk... what counter information and from whom are you claiming I deserve suspension?** Answered above.
15. **If I wrote this email in my mother tongue of Gaeilge would you find that more misconstruingly offensive?** Answered above.
16. **You were quick to send me this suspension, what about a reply for the valid complaint I've already submitted to NUIG following your complaints process?** Answered above.
17. **What serious grounds, can you elaborate to me were deemed serious or concerning? Did I clog your IMAP servers?** Answered above.
18. **I will retain full right to contact my Disability Advisor Maeve McCaldin, though?** Answered above.
19. **I am a remote student, I live safe and sound in Belfast, your suspension and suggestion of myself from physically attending the campus is rather irrelevant and misinterpretation of my written text is not my prerogative – English is my second language. What makes you think your concerns are warranted?** Details of concerns that caused the temporary suspension and support under QA269 to be invoked have been recorded in a 'note of concern' that will be shared with you by the review panel as part of the stage 3 process.

Prof Ciara Meehan (she/her)

Déan na Mac Léinn | Dean of Students

Oifig Déan na Mac Léinn
Office of the Dean of Students



OLLSCOIL NA GAILLIMHE
UNIVERSITY OF GALWAY

University
ofGalway.ie

Uimhir Carthanachta Cláraithe/Registered Charity Number 20002107

From: MAC LIATHÁIN, CIAN <C.MACLIATHAIN2@universityofgalway.ie>
Sent: 20 September 2024 18:07
To: Dean of Students <deanofstudents@universityofgalway.ie>
Cc: McCaldin, Maeve <maeve.mccaldin@universityofgalway.ie>
Subject: Thanks for the Notice, what about the complaint submitted first? Re: Notice of Temporary Suspension and Support under QA269

Your concerns for my wellbeing are unwarranted. I am not in crisis, what gave you that impression?

Staff members I emailed regarding ongoing educational issues I am experiencing know me quite well, or may remember me better if they read my previous assignments or their previous feedback to me.

I am a remote student, I live safe and sound in Belfast, your suspension and suggestion of myself from physically attending the campus is rather irrelevant and misinterpretation of my written text is not my prerogative – English is my second language. What makes you think your concerns are warranted? I am emancipated from my family, and am free to answer any direct questions, in writing obviously, for my protection.

Any and all emails I sent previously, could be replied to asking for further clarification of why it was sent and CCed to educator obliged to support a star student of the Bachelor of Mathematics & Education.

At no point was I advised not to email lecturers relevant to my current and future education. Do you think me delusional, grandiose for having the courage to speak out about the below:

I was previously an inpatient of one Professor Colm McDonald.

His conflict of interest was identified to him previously as he was a lecturer to my famous older brother Craig Mac Liatháin who claimed I had psychosis when I told him that I was diagnosed with an anxiety disorder and Post-Traumatic Stress Disorder by one Dr James McLaughlin.

He thought this was a psychotic break because my stepfather is called James O Loughlin.

I identified Professor McDonald's conflict of interest and his successive denial of this lead to him accidentally or purposefully committing malpractice at my expense. He out of spite prescribed increasing doses of brain damaging neuroleptics (a chemical proven by Dr Peter Breggin's work and origination in relation to Auschwitz (Models of Madness, forgot year) later publications regarding the efficacy of medical marijuana in opposition to this. Those fraudulently prescribed neuroleptics have been out of my system for 6 months and I'm doing quite well thank you despite a need for a prescription to ventolin, protopic and medical marijuana which is in progress here in the United Kingdom.

I was the victim of multiple assaults here in Belfast but am receiving physical care from the NHS, multiple hits to the head and exacerbation of my previous spinal damage. Also false allegations from staff members of Queen's University Belfast when I followed their official complaints procedure advising them of a bouncer and a disability advisor who committed educational prejudice and a hate crime.

I am registered with your Disability Office with CPTSD and anxiety disorder.

Your insinuation that I am in crisis and suspended to await

Professor Meehan, I have submitted a valid complaint previously against NUIG Security for assaults on my body occurring in Summer 2019 by Security + Gardaí and

Security for assaults on my body occurring in Summer 2019 by Security / Garda and also in Summer 2023 by the bouncer of Sult / College Bar.

I am not in crisis.

Did I threaten anyone or claim to be aggressive or self-harming?

With all due respect, Professor Michelle Millar – the previous Dean of Students was very supportive of me when I was previously homeless for 6 months.

I have further evidence to my claims, safety and clean bill of mental health something which I manage quite well via bibliotherapy and the entourage effect of legal CBD herb.

I am rather educated by virtue of the inspiring lectures that granted me my Bachelor in Arts of Mathematics and Education (educational psychology, sociology,, my Higher Diploma in Software Design and Development and my Dioplóma sa Ghaeilge (C1) where I received first-class honours in each.

Your sudden suspension without clarifying questions is educationally biased and severely traumatising to insinuate I am a risk to other on campus in the first never mind remotely from Belfast? Do you find that question offensive? I thought the Dean of Students was obligated to protect students and promote them to feel a sense of safety

The President doesn't know me, if you have misinterpreted any previous emails, feel free to forward them back to me and ask why I sent it to whom when?

Mise le meas díoma agus mífhoighne leis an false allegation of threats to safety to myself or others,

Cian Mac Liatháin Uí Dhéisigh

Cian Lyons Deacy, the Deacy's whom Terryland Park was named after when my uncle died and their heritage as part of the tribe of Morris of Galway.

P.S.

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From: Dean of Students <deanofstudents@universityofgalway.ie>

Date: Friday, 20 September 2024 at 14:24

To: MAC LIATHÁIN, CIAN <C.MACLIATHAIN2@universityofgalway.ie>

Subject: Notice of Temporary Suspension and Support under QA269

**For the attention of Cian Mac Liatháin (11476078)
Notice of Temporary Suspension and Support under QA269 Support for
Students in Crisis Policy**

Dear Cian,

I am writing to inform you that the President, Professor Peter McHugh, having

consulted as appropriate, is of the opinion that there are sufficiently serious grounds for concerns about your behaviour and well-being, as exhibited through your extensive and repeated emails to staff, to invoke an immediate temporary suspension under Section 9 and Appendix 5 of QA269 Support for Students in Crisis policy (please see attached).

This is a temporary measure, taken with a view to the duty of care owed to both yourself and the University community. The decision has been exercised with due regard to natural justice and fair procedure.

Please note, this temporary suspension shall not be regarded as an indication as to whether or not the grounds for concern is proven.

Next Steps

- In my capacity as Dean of Students, I will now invoke Stage 3 of QA269 Support for Students in Crisis policy, and a review panel will engage with you to determine the supports necessary.
- The time period for the suspension has not yet been determined. This will be assessed by the review panel.
- We will endeavour to move as expeditiously as possible to arrange a meeting of the review panel. We do not expect there to be a lengthy wait, but we will need to follow the steps outlined in the policy (attached).
- In line with Appendix 5, point 6 of the policy, every reasonable effort will be made to support you to continue your academic studies:
 - You may continue to engage with those aspects of your course where materials are available on Canvas, including pre-recorded lectures.
 - You shall not attend the live lectures, campus-based activities, or engage with the discussion board elements of the course.
- Throughout your suspension, you are not permitted to physically access the campus.
- Throughout your suspension, all queries must be directed to deanofstudents@universityofgalway.ie only. Other emails should not be copied into the correspondence. Should this not be respected, the University will have to take measures to temporarily restrict your email access. Reasonable response times apply.
- Throughout your suspension, you retain the right to access University of Galway Student Counselling Service. Sessions can be delivered online. Should you wish to avail of this service, please email deanofstudents@universityofgalway.ie and the Office of the Dean of Students will make the arrangements.

The University will notify you of next steps in due course having regard to the requirements of the QA269 Support for Students in Crisis policy.

Regards,

Ciara

Prof Ciara Meehan (she/her)
Déan na Mac Léinn | Dean of Students

Oifig Déan na Mac Léinn
Office of the Dean of Students



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